

GAME-MASTER'S SETUP GUIDE • REMOVE THESE LEAVES BEFORE SHE ARRIVES

MINUTE ONE

HANDED TO HER: the letter and the Milk Crate painting.
Letter gives sarahs.quest and ends: breathe in, breathe out.

OUT IN THE OPEN: the nine printables, the flyer, the lemons,
the knife AND the scale, The Prophet, the locked suitcase.

OPEN AT THE SAME TIME • two lines, either order

Milk Crate painting, back → Ed Sheeran

Stars and Their Notes → The Barista's Hornpipe, two notes

Parlour Songbook, those two shapes → 12 and 15

Concordance + The Prophet, pages 12 and 15 → CORN BREAD

Receipt Book, cornbread → a game of backgammon

BACKGAMMON SET
Plate II • the Patricia painting

Put the knife on the scale → 79 g

Knife Catalogue, 79 g → No. 9, the Lemonade Knife

Cut the lemons open → the Joker

Cartomancer's Guide, the Joker → in the Dutch oven

DUTCH OVEN
Plate I • the DARK BLUE key

OPENS WHEN THE MUSIC LINE IS DONE

Patricia painting → Register → a small painted egg...

WINGSPAN BOX
Hamlet painting • fairy painting • a Queen of Hearts

THREE AT ONCE • any order

Queen of Hearts → Cartomancer's Guide
→ the back of the upstairs toilet

TOILET CISTERN
the BLACK key

Hamlet → Hamnet → Chloé Zhao
→ Register, Chloe → a young tree in a pot

THE BONSAI
blue-light pen • Abyssinia & Gleaners paintings

Fairy houses → Shirley
→ Register → a bottle kept for company

LIQUOR CABINET
the Pig-Pen Alphabet sheet

THE LOCK • needs a piece from every line

Abyssinia painting + pigpen sheet → sarahs.quest,
the Ethiopian flag is Plate VII, turned over → HALF PAST THREE

Flyer → bathroom. Blue-light pen + pigpen sheet
under ALIEN BLUES: BREATHE IN BREATHE OUT LOOK INSIDE

INSIDE THE MEDITATION CUSHION
the card, in wheel symbols

THE WHEEL: pin Plate II on Plate I, set the hands to 3:30, decode the card
H₅W 6WJ OQOY H₅W L8WWZW8 = THE KEY IS IN THE FREEZER

THE FREEZER • the PURPLE key, in a ziplock

BLACK key (cistern)
opens the SUITCASE

DARK BLUE key (Dutch oven)
opens the BACKPACK inside it

**PURPLE key opens the
COMPARTMENT: the prize**

Nothing can be shortcut: the card is unreadable without both plates and the time, and those come from three different places.

PLAIN ENGLISH FOR THE THINGS WITH ODD NAMES

THE CONCORDANCE

The one-page sheet headed "A Reader's Concordance" with "The Prophet, by Kahlil Gibran" printed under the masthead. It gives one word-counting rule for each of 84 pages. She needs a real copy of The Prophet to use it; the sheet itself names the book, so put the book on the shelf among others and nothing more is needed.

PLATE I AND PLATE II

The two circles on the cipher-wheel pages. Plate I, "The Dial", is the big one with clock numerals round the rim. Plate II, "The Hands", is the smaller one with two clock hands printed on it. Cut both out. Push a brad (split pin) through the centre of Plate I and tape it there; she pins Plate II on top and turns it until the hands read 3:30.

PIGPEN

A cipher where each letter is drawn as the walls of the box it sits in. The printed Pig-Pen Alphabet sheet is the key. The only pigpen you write by hand is the wall; the flags' pigpen is already on the website.

WHEEL SYMBOLS

Ordinary letters and digits that only mean something once the wheel is set. You copy them onto the cushion card exactly as printed below.

LOCK AND LOAD, IN THIS ORDER, SO NO KEY ENDS UP LOCKED INSIDE ITS OWN BOX

1. Put the prize in the backpack's inner compartment. Padlock that compartment. Set its key aside: this is **PURPLE**.
2. Close the backpack's main zip. Padlock it. Set its key aside: **DARK BLUE**.
3. Put the backpack inside the suitcase. Padlock the suitcase. Set its key aside: **BLACK**.
4. Leave the suitcase somewhere she will see it all evening. It is meant to taunt.
5. Now hide the three keys: **BLACK** in a ziplock in the toilet cistern; **DARK BLUE** in the Dutch oven with Plate I; **PURPLE** in a ziplock bag in the freezer, behind something frozen. Nothing points at the freezer until she decodes the wheel, so it stays unsearched.
6. **LIGHT BLUE** and its lock are not used. Put them in a drawer.

EVERY HIDING PLACE AND WHAT GOES IN IT

PLACE	CONTENTS
HER HANDS	The welcome letter and the Milk Crate painting. Nothing is hidden on the painting; its back just carries the written clue.
OUT IN THE OPEN	The nine printables scattered about; the flyer on the fridge; a bowl of lemons, one loaded; the knife and the kitchen scale on the counter; The Prophet on the shelf among many books; the locked suitcase
BACKGAMMON SET	Plate II; the Patricia painting
WINGSPAN BOX	The Hamlet painting; the fairy painting; a real Queen of Hearts playing card
TOILET CISTERN	The BLACK key in a ziplock bag. Nothing else. No paper, no paintings.
THE BONSAI	The blue-light pen; the Abyssinia painting; the Gleaners painting (in a bag, under or beside the pot, not buried)
LIQUOR CABINET	The Pig-Pen Alphabet key sheet
DUTCH OVEN	Plate I with a brad taped to it; the DARK BLUE key
BATHROOM WALL OR MIRROR	ALIEN BLUES in dry-erase marker; the pigpen glyphs from the tracing sheet in invisible ink beneath
INSIDE THE MEDITATION CUSHION	The card of wheel symbols, in a small envelope, just inside the zip
THE FREEZER	The PURPLE key in a ziplock, tucked behind the frozen peas. Nothing points here until the wheel is decoded.
SUITCASE	The backpack. Padlocked with the BLACK lock.
BACKPACK	The prize in its inner compartment, padlocked with the PURPLE lock; the main zip padlocked with the DARK BLUE lock

EXACTLY WHAT TO WRITE BY HAND, AND WHERE

THE BATHROOM WALL OR MIRROR. In dry-erase marker, large: ALIEN BLUES. Directly beneath it, in the invisible-ink pen, copy the pigpen shapes from the tracing sheet (the page before this guide). They read BREATHE IN BREATHE OUT LOOK INSIDE. Test a corner first: glazed tile and glass wipe clean, grout and stone do not. The mirror is the safest surface.

THE CUSHION CARD. Any scrap of paper or index card will do. Write in capitals, exactly: H 5 W 6 W J O Q O Y H 5 W L 8 W W Z W 8. Put it in a small envelope. On the envelope: *This will mean nothing until the hour is set.* Tuck it just inside the cushion's zip.

THE SIX PAINTING BACKS. Write on the quarter-sheet frames and attach one to each painting.

Milk Crate: *The famous man we always see here, who is not him.*

Patricia's: *Just the name. Look her up.*

Hamlet: *We saw the film of this play. Whose film was it?*

Fairy houses: *What was the family name of the one who lived here?*

Abyssinia: *Find this country's colours at sarahs.quest, and turn them over.*

Gleaners: *The café sits in a market named for a country. Its colours are at sarahs.quest too.*

THE WELCOME LETTER. Your words. It must contain the address sarahs.quest, may mention that not everything can be read on the day it is found, and must end with the line *breathe in, breathe out.*

NOTHING ELSE IS HANDWRITTEN. The flags' pigpen is on the website. The register, the card guide, the concordance and the rest are printed and final.

BEFORE SHE ARRIVES: THE FIVE TESTS

1. Put your real knife on your real scale. It must read 79 g. Nearest catalogue entries are 58 g and 99 g.
2. Open your copy of The Prophet. Page 12, fourth word of the first line must be **corn**. Page 15, the first sentence beginning "Give", sixth word must be **bread**. If either fails, tell me the real page numbers and I will reprint the concordance.
3. Shine the blue-light pen on the wall. The pigpen must show. Then wipe a corner to be sure it comes off.
4. Pin the plates, set 3:30, decode the cushion card yourself. It must read THE KEY IS IN THE FREEZER.
5. Open sarahs.quest on your phone, tap Plate VII, confirm the pigpen on the back reads HALF PAST THREE.

IF SHE STALLS

sarahs.quest/hints.html: eighteen predicaments, each with a nudge, a firmer nudge, and the answer. Linked from the bottom of the flags page. Or just tell her; you are allowed.